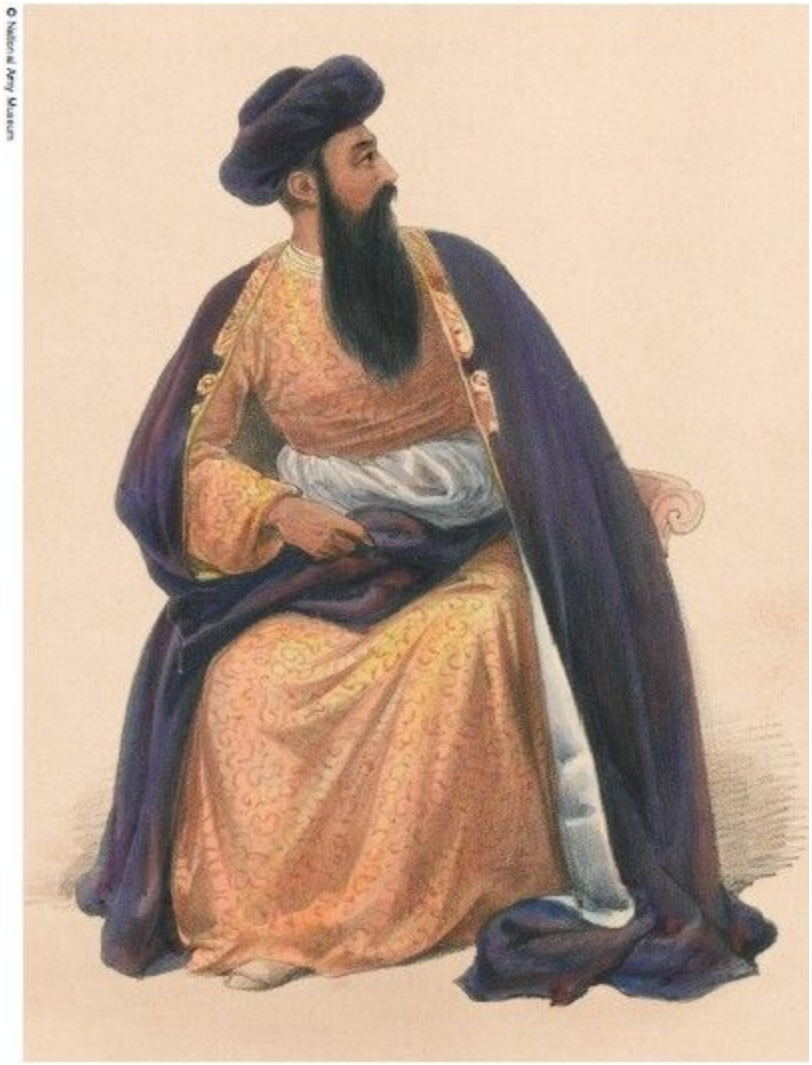


Shah Shuja, grandson of Ahmad Shah Abdali and the head of the Sadozai clan, ruled the remains of his grandfather's empire from 1803: 'Our intention,' he wrote, 'was that from the moment of mounting the throne, we would so rule our subjects with justice and mercy, that they should live in happiness within the shade of our protecting wings.' Within six years he had been defeated by his Barakzai enemies and had had to flee into exile in India.